to rid Myanmar of “the lady” as the international community now called her. The regime monitored their phone conversations and began cutting them off when she was on the line with her husband. This cruel tactic was meant to inflict the maximum pain and suffering on Suu Kyi. She had no intention of leaving Myanmar to visit her dying husband. Aris passed away on March 27, 1999.

The struggle between Suu Kyi and the junta continued unabated. It was turning into a war of endurance between the generals and what remained of the democratic opposition. Suu Kyi's next step was to attempt to break free from Rangoon by traveling around drumming up support for what seemed at times an undefined cause. The military would stop her with roadblocks and either wait her out or at times force the vehicle to return to Rangoon. The military claimed to be protecting Suu Kyi from hostile crowds and possible violence. Eventually Suu Kyi would be placed under house arrest again. This second round of house arrest would last 19 months.

During the tumultuous early part of 2002, Than Shwe uncovered a plot against the regime. Members of Ne Win's family were implicated. A few weeks later, a thaw between the pro-democracy movement and the generals emerged. Subsequently, Japan cancelled Myanmar's debt, an act that may have been part of a deal to release Suu Kyi. Under Suu Kyi's guidance, democracy workshops were organized in close proximity to her residence. Only after patently waiting for months for some sort of positive response from the generals to participate in a meaningful dialogue did Suu Kyi make the decision to once again venture out of the capital.

Residents of the regions Suu Kyi would travel to were warned not to venture out to hear her speak. She traveled to the predominately Muslim area of Arakan. The military would place roadblocks or wire across the travel routes. Furthermore, the USDA members were out in force in order to intimidate residents and harass Suu Kyi's supporters. Suu Kyi ventured to the northern area of Myanmar visiting the Chin, Kachin, and Shan states. She now traveled with a larger contingent of bodyguards. Military intelligence was always out documenting and photographing the rallies. The pro-democracy movement seemed to be gathering support, to the dismay of the junta.